

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 3

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

027. Chapter 3 Verses 1-3

VERSE 3.1

अर्जुन उवाच ।
ज्यायसी चेत्कर्मणस्ते मता बुद्धिर्जनार्दन ।
तत्किं कर्मणि घोरे मां नियोजयसि केशव ॥१॥

arjuna uvācha
jyāyasī chet karmaṇas te matā buddhir janārdana
tat kiṁ karmaṇi ghore mām niyojayasi keśhava

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **jyāyasī**—superior; **chet**—if; **karmaṇaḥ**—than
fruitive action; **te**—by you; **matā**—is considered; **buddhiḥ**—intellect; **janārdana**
—he who looks after the public, Krishna; **tat**—then; **kim**—why; **karmaṇi**—
action; **ghore**—terrible; **mām**—me; **niyojayasi**—do you engage; **keśhava**—
Krishna, the killer of the demon named Keshi;

**Arjuna said: O Krishna! If your belief is that knowledge is
superior to action, then why do you engage me in this
dreadful act of battle?**

VERSE 3.2

व्यामिश्रेणेव वाक्येन बुद्धिं मोहयसीव मे ।
तदेकं वद निश्चित्य येन श्रेयोऽहमाप्नुयाम् ॥२॥

vyāmiśhreṇeva vākyaena buddhiṁ mohayasīva me
tad ekam vada niśhchitya yena śhreyo 'ham āpnuyām

vyāmiśhreṇa iva—by your apparently ambiguous; **vākyaena**—words; **buddhiṁ**—intellect; **mohayasi**—I am getting bewildered; **iva**—as it were; **me**—my; **tat**—therefore; **ekam**—one; **vada**—please tell; **niśhchitya**—decisively; **yena**—by which; **śhreyah**—the highest good; **aham**—I; **āpnuyām**—may attain

With these apparently contradictory words, You seem to confuse my understanding. Therefore tell me definitely that one thing by which I shall reach the Highest Goal.

VERSE 3.3

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

लोकेऽस्मिन्द्विविधा निष्ठा पुरा प्रोक्ता मया नघ ।

ज्ञानयोगेन साङ्ख्यानां कर्मयोगेन योगिनाम् ॥ ३ ॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

loke 'smin dvi-vidhā niṣṭhā purā proktā mayānagha

jñāna-yogena sāṅkhyānām karma-yogena yoginām

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Blessed Lord said; **loke**—in the world; **asmin**—this; **dvi-vidhā**—two kinds of; **niṣṭhā**—faith; **purā**—previously; **proktā**—explained; **mayā**—by me (Shree Krishna); **anagha**—sinless; **jñāna-yogena**—through the path of knowledge; **sāṅkhyānām**—for those inclined toward contemplation; **karma-yogena**—through the path of action; **yoginām**—of the yogis

The Blessed Lord said: O sinless Arjuna! In ancient times two paths of spiritual description were spoken by me – the Jnana yoga for the followers of the path of knowledge, and Karma yoga for the followers of the path of action.

028. Chapter 3 Verses 4-6

VERSE 3.4

न कर्मणामनारम्भान्नैष्कर्म्यं पुरुषोऽश्नुते ।
न च संन्यसनादेव सिद्धिं समधिगच्छति ॥४॥

na karmaṇām anārambhān naiṣhkarmyam puruṣho 'śhnute
na cha sannyasanād eva siddhim samadhigachchhati

na—not; **karmaṇām**—of actions; **anārambhāt**—by abstaining from;
naiṣhkarmyam—freedom from karmic reactions; **puruṣhaḥ**—a person;
aśhnute—attains; **na**—not; **cha**—and; **sannyasanāt**—by renunciation; **eva**—
only; **siddhim**—perfection; **samadhigachchhati**—attains

Man does not match the actionless state of Brahman by mere non-performance of work, nor does he attain perfection by renunciation only.

VERSE 3.5

न हि कश्चित्क्षणमपि जातु तिष्ठत्यकर्मकृत् ।
कार्यते ह्यवशः कर्म सर्वः प्रकृतिजैर्गुणैः ॥५॥

na hi kaśhchit kṣhaṇam api jātu tiṣṭhatyakarma-kṛit
kāryate hyavaśhaḥ karma sarvaḥ prakṛiti-jair guṇaiḥ

na—not; **hi**—certainly; **kaśhchit**—anyone; **kṣhaṇam**—a moment; **api**—even; **jātu**—ever; **tiṣṭhati**—can remain; **akarma-kṛit**—without action; **kāryate**—are performed; **hi**—certainly; **avaśhaḥ**—helpless; **karma**—work; **sarvaḥ**—all; **prakṛiti-jaiḥ**—born of material nature; **guṇaiḥ**—by the qualities

No one can live even for a moment without doing work.

**Everyone without his will is made to do work by the qualities
born of Prakriti.**

VERSE 3.6

कर्मेन्द्रियाणि संयम्य य आस्ते मनसा स्मरन् ।
इन्द्रियार्थान्विमूढात्मा मिथ्याचारः स उच्यते ॥६॥

karmendriyāṇi sanyamya ya āste manasā smaran
indriyārthān vimūḍhātmā mithyāchārah sa uchyate

karma-indriyāṇi—the organs of action; **sanyamya**—restrain; **yaḥ**—who; **āste**—remain; **manasā**—in the mind; **smaran**—to remember; **indriya-arthān**—sense objects; **vimūḍha-ātmā**—the deluded; **mithyā-āchārah**—hypocrite; **saḥ**—they; **uchyate**—are called

The man of deluded understanding who restraining the organs of the action sits contemplating the sense objects with the mind is called a hypocrite.

029. Chapter 3 Verses 7-8

VERSE 3.7

यस्त्विन्द्रियाणि मनसा नियम्यारभतेऽर्जुन ।
कर्मेन्द्रियैः कर्मयोगमसक्तः स विशिष्यते ॥७॥

yas tvindriyāṇi manasā niyamyārabhate 'rjuna
karmendriyaiḥ karma-yogam asaktaḥ sa viśhiṣhyate

yaḥ—who; **tu**—but; **indriyāṇi**—the senses; **manasā**—by the mind; **niyamya**—control; **ārabhate**—begins; **arjuna**—Arjun; **karma-indriyaiḥ**—by the working senses; **karma-yogam**—karm yog; **asaktaḥ**—without attachment; **saḥ**—they; **viśhiṣhyate**—are superior

But, O Arjuna! he who controls the senses with the mind, and commences the discipline of Karma yoga by his organs of action without attachment, is the best.

VERSE 3.8

नियतं कुरु कर्म त्वं कर्म ज्यायो ह्यकर्मणः ।
शरीरयात्रापि च ते न प्रसिद्ध्येदकर्मणः ॥ ८ ॥

niyatam kuru karma tvam karma jyāyo hyakarmaṇaḥ
śharīra-yātrāpi cha te na prasiddhyed akarmaṇaḥ

niyatam—constantly; **kuru**—perform; **karma**—Vedic duties; **tvam**—you; **karma**—action; **jyāyaḥ**—superior; **hi**—certainly; **akarmaṇaḥ**—than inaction; **śharīra**—bodily; **yātrā**—maintenance; **api**—even; **cha**—and; **te**—your; **na prasiddhyet**—would not be possible; **akarmaṇaḥ**—inaction

Doing the work prescribed by the Sastras is superior to inaction. By inaction, even maintenance of the body for you would not be possible

030. Chapter 3 Verses 9-16

VERSE 3.9

यज्ञार्थात्कर्मणोऽन्यत्र लोकोऽयं कर्मबन्धनः ।
तदर्थं कर्म कौन्तेय मुक्तसङ्गः समाचर ॥९॥

yajñārthāt karmaṇo 'nyatra loko 'yaṁ karma-bandhanaḥ
tad-arthaṁ karma kaunteya mukta-saṅgaḥ samāchara

yajña-arthāt—for the sake of sacrifice; **karmaṇaḥ**—than action; **anyatra**—else; **lokaḥ**—material world; **ayam**—this; **karma-bandhanaḥ**—bondage through one's work; **tat**—that; **arthaṁ**—for the sake of; **karma**—action; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **mukta-saṅgaḥ**—free from attachment; **samāchara**—perform properly

O Arjuna! Works other than those performed for the sake of sacrifice (Yajna) binds this world. So perform work for sacrifice without attachment.

VERSE 3.10

सहयज्ञाः प्रजाः सृष्ट्वा पुरोवाच प्रजापतिः ।
अनेन प्रसविष्यध्वमेष वो ऽस्त्विष्टकामधुक् ॥ 10 ॥

saha-yajñāḥ prajāḥ sṛiṣṭvā purovācha prajāpatiḥ
anena prasaviṣhyadhvam eṣha vo 'stviṣṭa-kāma-dhuk

saha—along with; **yajñāḥ**—sacrifices; **prajāḥ**—humankind; **sṛiṣṭvā**—created;
purā—in beginning; **uvācha**—said; **prajā-patiḥ**—Brahma; **anena**—by this;
prasaviṣhyadhvam—increase prosperity; **eṣhaḥ**—these; **vaḥ**—your; **astu**—shall
be; **iṣṭa-kāma-dhuk**—bestower of all wishes

Having created mankind together with yajna in the beginning, Brahma (Creator) said – “By this shall you propagate; it shall be to you the milk-cow of desires, the wish-fulfilling heavenly cow Kamadhenu.”

VERSE 3.11

देवान्भावयतानेन ते देवा भावयन्तु वः ।
परस्परं भावयन्तः श्रेयः परमवाप्स्यथ ॥ 11 ॥

devān bhāvayatānena te devā bhāvayantu vaḥ
parasparam bhāvayantaḥ śhreyaḥ param avāpsyatha

devān—celestial gods; **bhāvayatā**—will be pleased; **anena**—by these (sacrifices);
te—those; **devāḥ**—celestial gods; **bhāvayantu**—will be pleased; **vaḥ**—you;
parasparam—one another; **bhāvayantaḥ**—pleasing one another; **śhreyaḥ**—
prosperity; **param**—the supreme; **avāpsyatha**—shall achieve

**Nourish the Gods with Yajna, and they shall nourish you, and
thus nourishing one another both men and Gods you shall
attain the highest good.**

VERSE 3.12

इष्टान्भोगान्हि वो देवा दास्यन्ते यज्ञभाविताः ।
तैर्दत्तानप्रदायैभ्यो यो भुङ्क्ते स्तेन एव सः ॥ 12 ॥

iṣṭān bhogān hi vo devā dāsyante yajña-bhāvitāḥ
tair dattān apradāyaibhyo yo bhuṅkte stena eva saḥ

iṣṭān—desired; **bhogān**—necessities of life; **hi**—certainly; **vaḥ**—unto you; **devāḥ**—the celestial gods; **dāsyante**—will grant; **yajña-bhāvitāḥ**—satisfied by sacrifice; **taiḥ**—by them; **dattān**—things granted; **apradāya**—without offering; **ebhyaḥ**—to them; **yaḥ**—who; **bhuṅkte**—enjoys; **stenaḥ**—thieves; **eva**—verily; **saḥ**—they

Nourished by sacrifice, the Gods, give you desirable enjoyments. He who enjoys objects given by the Gods without offering them is verily a thief.

VERSE 3.13

यज्ञशिष्टाशिनः सन्तो मुच्यन्ते सर्वकिल्बिषैः ।
भुञ्जते ते त्वघं पापा ये पचन्त्यात्मकारणात् ॥ 13 ॥

yajña-śhiṣṭāśhinaḥ santo muchyante sarva-kilbiṣhaiḥ
bhuñjate te tvaghaṁ pāpā ye pachantyātma-kāraṇāt

yajña-śhiṣṭa—of remnants of food offered in sacrifice; aśhinaḥ—eaters; santaḥ—saintly persons; muchyante—are released; sarva—all kinds of; kilbiṣhaiḥ—from sins; bhuñjate—enjoy; te—they; tu—but; agham—sins; pāpāḥ—sinners; ye—who; pachanti—cook (food); ātma-kāraṇāt—for their own sake

The righteous who offer food to the Gods in sacrifice and eat the remnants are freed from all sins. But those who cook food to satisfy their own needs, are sinners and verily eat sin.

अन्नाद्भवन्ति भूतानि पर्जन्यादन्नसम्भवः ।
यज्ञाद्भवति पर्जन्यो यज्ञः कर्मसमुद्भवः ॥ 14 ॥
कर्म ब्रह्मोद्भवं विद्धि ब्रह्माक्षरसमुद्भवम् ।
तस्मात्सर्वगतं ब्रह्म नित्यं यज्ञे प्रतिष्ठितम् ॥ 15 ॥

annād bhavanti bhūtāni parjanyaḥ anna-sambhavaḥ
yajñād bhavati parjanyaḥ yajñaḥ karma-samudbhavaḥ
karma brahmodbhavaṁ viddhi brahmākṣhara-samudbhavam
tasmāt sarva-gataṁ brahma nityaṁ yajñe pratiṣṭhitam

annāt—from food; **bhavanti**—subsist; **bhūtāni**—living beings; **parjanyaḥ**—from rains; **anna**—of food grains; **sambhavaḥ**—production; **yajñāt**—from the performance of sacrifice; **bhavati**—becomes possible; **parjanyaḥ**—rain; **yajñaḥ**—performance of sacrifice; **karma**—prescribed duties; **samudbhavaḥ**—born of

Beings are born of food, food is produced from rain, rain arises from yajna, yajna is born of action, action arises from Vedas, Vedas are born from the Imperishable Paramatma; therefore know that the Supreme Being is established in the yajna.

VERSE 3.16

एवं प्रवर्तितं चक्रं नानुवर्तयतीह यः ।
अघायुरिन्द्रियारामो मोघं पार्थ स जीवति ॥ 16 ॥

evam pravartitam chakram nānuvartayatīha yaḥ
aghāyur indriyārāmo mogham pārtha sa jīvati

evam—thus; **pravartitam**—set into motion; **chakram**—cycle; **na**—not;
anuvartayati—follow; **iha**—in this life; **yaḥ**—who; **agha-āyuh**—sinful living;
indriya-ārāmaḥ—for the delight of their senses; **mogham**—vainly; **pārtha**—
Arjun, the son of Pritha; **sah**—they; **jīvati**—live

The man who does not follow the cycle thus set revolving is a sinner rejoicing in sense-pleasures and he lives in vain.

031. Chapter 3 Verses 16-18

VERSE 3.16

एवं प्रवर्तितं चक्रं नानुवर्तयतीह यः ।
अघायुरिन्द्रियारामो मोघं पार्थ स जीवति ॥ 16 ॥

evam pravartitam chakram nānuvartayatīha yaḥ
aghāyur indriyārāmo mogham pārtha sa jīvati

evam—thus; pravartitam—set into motion; chakram—cycle; na—not; anuvartayati—follow; iha—in this life; yaḥ—who; agha-āyuh—sinful living; indriya-ārāmaḥ—for the delight of their senses; mogham—vainly; pārtha—Arjun, the son of Pritha; saḥ—they; jīvati—live

The man who does not follow the cycle thus set revolving is a sinner rejoicing in sense-pleasures and he lives in vain.

VERSE 3.17

यस्त्वात्मरतिरेव स्यादात्मतृप्तश्च मानवः ।
आत्मन्येव च सन्तुष्टस्तस्य कार्यं न विद्यते ॥17॥

yas tvātma-ratir eva syād ātma-trīptaśh cha mānavaḥ
ātmanyeva cha santuṣṭas tasya kāryam na vidyate

yaḥ—who; tu—but; ātma-ratiḥ—rejoice in the self; eva—certainly; syāt—is;
ātma-trīptaḥ—self-satisfied; cha—and; mānavaḥ—human being; ātmani—in
the self; eva—certainly; cha—and; santuṣṭaḥ—satisfied; tasya—his; kāryam—
duty; na—not; vidyate—exist

**But he who rejoices, who is contented, who finds happiness
in Atma only, has no work to perform.**

VERSE 3.18

नैव तस्य कृतेनार्थो नाकृतेनेह कश्चन ।
न चास्य सर्वभूतेषु कश्चिदर्थव्यपाश्रयः ॥ 18 ॥

naiva tasya kṛitenārtho nākṛiteneha kaśhchana
na chāsyā sarva-bhūteṣhu kaśhchid artha-vyapāśhrayaḥ

na—not; **eva**—indeed; **tasya**—his; **kṛitena**—by discharge of duty; **arthaḥ**—gain;
na—not; **akṛitena**—without discharge of duty; **iha**—here; **kaśhchana**—
whatsoever; **na**—never; **cha**—and; **asya**—of that person; **sarva-bhūteṣhu**—
among all living beings; **kaśhchid**—any; **artha**—necessity; **vyapāśhrayaḥ**—to
depend upon

**For him, there is in this world no interest whatsoever by
work done or not done. He does not depend upon any being
for any object.**

032. Chapter 3 Verses 19-21

VERSE 3.19

तस्मादसक्तः सततं कार्यं कर्म समाचर ।
असक्तो ह्याचरन्कर्म परमाप्नोति पूरुषः ॥ 19 ॥

tasmād asaktaḥ satataṁ kāryaṁ karma samāchara
asakto hyācharan karma param āpnoti pūruṣhaḥ

tasmāt—therefore; **asaktaḥ**—without attachment; **satatam**—constantly; **kāryam**—duty; **karma**—action; **samāchara**—perform; **asaktaḥ**—unattached; **hi**—certainly; **ācharan**—performing; **karma**—work; **param**—the Supreme; **āpnoti**—attains; **pūruṣhaḥ**—a person

Therefore that work which should be done, do it well always without attachment. He who performs all the prescribed duties in a detached spirit will attain the Supreme.

VERSE 3.20

कर्मणैव हि संसिद्धिमास्थिता जनकादयः ।
लोकसंग्रहमेवापि सम्पश्यन्कर्तुमर्हसि ॥ 20 ॥

karmaṇaiva hi sansiddhim āsthitā janakādayaḥ
loka-saṅgraham evāpi sampaśhyan kartum arhasi

karmaṇā—by the performance of prescribed duties; **eva**—only; **hi**—certainly; **sansiddhim**—perfection; **āsthitāḥ**—attained; **janaka-ādayaḥ**—King Janak and other kings; **loka-saṅgraham**—for the welfare of the masses; **eva api**—only; **sampaśhyan**—considering; **kartum**—to perform; **arhasi**—you should;

King Janaka and others attained perfection by action. Even having in view the need to show the right path to the masses, you should work.

VERSE 3.21

यद्यदाचरति श्रेष्ठस्तत्तदेवेतरो जनः ।
स यत्प्रमाणं कुरुते लोकस्तदनुवर्तते ॥ 21 ॥

yad yad ācharati śhreṣṭhas tat tad evetaro janah
sa yat pramāṇam kurute lokas tad anuvartate

yat yat—whatever; ācharati—does; śhreṣṭhaḥ—the best; tat tat—that (alone);
eva—certainly; itaraḥ—common; janah—people; saḥ—they; yat—whichever;
pramāṇam—standard; kurute—perform; lokaḥ—world; tat—that; anuvartate
—pursues

**What-so-ever a great man does, that other men do; whatever
he sets up as the standard, that the world follows.**

033. Chapter 3 Verses 22-26

VERSE 3.22

न मे पार्थास्ति कर्तव्यं त्रिषु लोकेषु किञ्चन ।
नानवाप्तमवाप्तव्यं वर्त एव च कर्मणि ॥ 22 ॥

na me pārthāsti kartavyam triṣhu lokeṣhu kiñchana
nānavāptam avāptavyam varta eva cha karmaṇi

na—not; **me**—mine; **pārtha**—Arjun; **asti**—is; **kartavyam**—duty; **triṣhu**—in the three; **lokeṣhu**—worlds; **kiñchana**—any; **na**—not; **anavāptam**—to be attained; **avāptavyam**—to be gained; **varte**—I am engaged; **eva**—yet; **cha**—also; **karmaṇi**—in prescribed duties

There is no duty for me to do in the three worlds. There is nothing unattained or to be attained for me. And yet I am also engaged in work.

VERSE 3.23

यदि ह्यहं न वर्तेयं जातु कर्मण्यतन्द्रितः ।
मम वर्त्मानुवर्तन्ते मनुष्याः पार्थ सर्वशः ॥ 23 ॥

yadi hyaham na varteyam jātu karmaṇyatandritaḥ
mama vartmānuvartante manuṣhyāḥ pārtha sarvaśhaḥ

yadi—if; hi—certainly; aham—I; na—not; varteyam—thus engage; jātu—ever;
karmaṇi—in the performance of prescribed duties; atandritaḥ—carefully;
mama—my; vartma—path; anuvartante—follow; manuṣhyāḥ—all men; pārtha
—Arjun, the son of Pritha; sarvaśhaḥ—in all respects

**If I am not engaged in action always, without relaxation,
men follow my path in every way, O Arjuna!**

VERSE 3.24

उत्सीदेयुरिमे लोका न कुर्यां कर्म चेदहम् ।

सङ्करस्य च कर्ता स्यामुपहन्यामिमाः प्रजाः ॥ 24 ॥

utsīdeyur ime lokā na kuryām karma ched aham

sankarasya cha kartā syām upahanyām imāḥ prajāḥ

utsīdeyuḥ—would perish; **ime**—all these; **lokāḥ**—worlds; **na**—not; **kuryām**—I perform; **karma**—prescribed duties; **chet**—if; **aham**—I; **sankarasya**—of uncultured population; **cha**—and; **kartā**—responsible; **syām**—would be; **upahanyām**—would destroy; **imāḥ**—all these; **prajāḥ**—living entities

These worlds would perish if I do not perform work; I would be the cause of the confusion of species and the destruction of these beings.

VERSE 3.25

सक्ताः कर्मण्यविद्वांसो यथा कुर्वन्ति भारत ।
कुर्याद्विद्वांस्तथासक्तश्चिकीर्षुर्लोकसंग्रहम् ॥ 25 ॥

saktāḥ karmaṇyavidvāṁso yathā kurvanti bhārata
kuryād vidvāns tathāsaktaśh chikīrṣhur loka-saṅgraham

saktāḥ—attached; **karmaṇi**—duties; **avidvānsaḥ**—the ignorant; **yathā**—as much as; **kurvanti**—act; **bhārata**—scion of Bharat (Arjun); **kuryāt**—should do; **vidvān**—the wise; **tathā**—thus; **asaktaḥ**—unattached; **chikīrṣhuḥ**—wishing; **loka-saṅgraham**—welfare of the world

O Arjuna! As the ignorant men work with attachment to action, so should the wise act without attachment, for the welfare of the world.

VERSE 3.26

न बुद्धिभेदं जनयेदज्ञानां कर्मसङ्गिनाम् ।
जोषयेत्सर्वकर्माणि विद्वान्युक्तः समाचरन् ॥ 26 ॥

na buddhi-bhedam janayed ajñānām karma-saṅginām
joṣhayet sarva-karmāṇi vidvān yuktaḥ samācharan

na—not; **buddhi-bhedam**—discord in the intellects; **janayet**—should create; **ajñānām**—of the ignorant; **karma-saṅginām**—who are attached to fruitive actions; **joṣhayet**—should inspire (them) to perform; **sarva**—all; **karmāṇi**—prescribed; **vidvān**—the wise; **yuktaḥ**—enlightened; **samācharan**—performing properly

The wise man should not disturb and confuse the minds of the ignorant attached to action. By performing all actions with yogic equanimity, they should make the ignorant do accordingly.

034. Chapter 3 Verse 27

VERSE 3.27

प्रकृतेः क्रियमाणानि गुणैः कर्माणि सर्वशः ।
अहङ्कारविमूढात्मा कर्ताहमिति मन्यते ॥ 27 ॥

prakṛiteḥ kriyamāṇāni guṇaiḥ karmāṇi sarvaśhaḥ
ahankāra-vimūḍhātmā kartāham iti manyate

prakṛiteḥ—of material nature; **kriyamāṇāni**—carried out; **guṇaiḥ**—by the three modes; **karmāṇi**—activities; **sarvaśhaḥ**—all kinds of; **ahankāra-vimūḍha-ātmā**—those who are bewildered by the ego and misidentify themselves with the body; **kartā**—the doer; **aham**—I; **iti**—thus; **manyate**—thinks

By the qualities of nature, actions are performed in all cases, but one whose mind is deluded by egoism thinks “I am the doer”.

035. Chapter 3 Verses 28-29

VERSE 3.28

तत्त्ववित्तु महाबाहो गुणकर्मविभागयोः ।
गुणा गुणेषु वर्तन्त इति मत्वा न सज्जते ॥ 28 ॥

tattva-vit tu mahā-bāho guṇa-karma-vibhāgayoḥ
guṇā guṇeṣhu vartanta iti matvā na sajjate

tattva-vit—the knower of the Truth; **tu**—but; **mahā-bāho**—mighty-armed one; **guṇa-karma**—from guṇas and karma; **vibhāgayoḥ**—distinguish; **guṇāḥ**—modes of material nature in the shape of the senses, mind, etc; **guṇeṣhu**—modes of material nature in the shape of objects of perception; **vartante**—are engaged; **iti**—thus; **matvā**—knowing; **na**—never; **sajjate**—becomes attached

O mighty-armed Arjuna! But the knower of Truth understands the divisions of qualities and functions. He knows that the qualities in the form of senses function amidst the objects of the senses, and he, as the Supreme Self, is not affected by them. Thus knowing, he remains unattached.

VERSE 3.29

प्रकृतेर्गुणसम्मूढाः सज्जन्ते गुणकर्मसु ।
तानकृत्स्नविदो मन्दान्कृत्स्नविन्न विचालयेत् ॥ 29 ॥

prakṛiter guṇa-sammūḍhāḥ sajjante guṇa-karmasu
tān akṛitsna-vido mandān kṛitsna-vin na vichālayet

prakṛiteḥ—of material nature; **guṇa**—by the modes of material nature; **sammūḍhāḥ**—deluded; **sajjante**—become attached; **guṇa-karmasu**—to results of actions; **tān**—those; **akṛitsna-vidaḥ**—persons without knowledge; **mandān**—the ignorant; **kṛitsna-vit**—persons with knowledge; **na vichālayet**—should not unsettle

The man of knowledge should not confuse the mind of those men of imperfect understanding who, deluded by the Gunas of Nature, are attached to action in the material world.

036. Chapter 3 Vers 30

VERSE 3.30

मयि सर्वाणि कर्माणि संन्यस्याध्यात्मचेतसा ।
निराशीर्निर्ममो भूत्वा युध्यस्व विगतज्वरः ॥ 30 ॥

mayi sarvāṇi karmāṇi sannyasyādhyātma-chetasā
nirāśhīr nirmamo bhūtvā yudhyasva vigata-jvaraḥ

mayi—unto me; **sarvāṇi**—all; **karmāṇi**—works; **sannyasya**—renouncing completely; **adhyātma-chetasā**—with the thoughts resting on God; **nirāśhīr**—free from hankering for the results of the actions; **nirmamaḥ**—without ownership; **bhūtvā**—so being; **yudhyasva**—fight; **vigata-jvaraḥ**—without mental fever

Renouncing all actions in Me with the mind fixed in Self, free from hope and egoism, fight without mental agitation.

037. Chapter 3 Vers 31

VERSE 3.31

ये मे मतमिदं नित्यमनुतिष्ठन्ति मानवाः ।
श्रद्धावन्तोऽनसूयन्तो मुच्यन्ते तेऽपि कर्मभिः ॥ 31 ॥

ye me matam idam nityam anutiṣṭhanti mānavāḥ
śhraddhāvanto 'nasūyanto muchyante te 'pi karmabhiḥ

ye—who; me—my; matam—teachings; idam—these; nityam—constantly;
anutiṣṭhanti—abide by; mānavāḥ—human beings; śhraddhā-vantaḥ—with
profound faith; anasūyantaḥ—free from cavilling; muchyante—become free; te
—those; api—also; karmabhiḥ—from the bondage of karma

**Those men who, with faith and free from ill-will, practice
this my teaching, are also freed from the bondage of action.**

038. Chapter 3 Verses 32-34

VERSE 3.32

ये त्वेतदभ्यसूयन्तो नानुतिष्ठन्ति मे मतम् ।
सर्वज्ञानविमूढांस्तान्विद्धि नष्टानचेतसः ॥ 32 ॥

ye tvetad abhyasūyanto nānutiṣṭhanti me matam
sarva-jñāna-vimūḍhāns tān viddhi naṣṭān achetasah

ye—those; tu—but; etat—this; abhyasūyantaḥ—cavilling; na—not; anutiṣṭhanti—follow; me—my; matam—teachings; sarva-jñāna—in all types of knowledge; vimūḍhān—deluded; tān—they are; viddhi—know; naṣṭān—ruined; achetasah—devoid of discrimination

**But those who carp at my teaching and do not practise it,
know them as men deluded in all knowledge, devoid of
discrimination and doomed to destruction.**

VERSE 3.33

सदृशं चेष्टते स्वस्याः प्रकृतेर्ज्ञानवानपि ।
प्रकृतिं यान्ति भूतानि निग्रहः किं करिष्यति ॥ ३३ ॥

sadṛiśhaṁ cheṣṭate svasyāḥ prakṛiter jñānavān api
prakṛitiṁ yānti bhūtāni nigrahaḥ kiṁ kariṣhyati

sadṛiśham—accordingly; **cheṣṭate**—act; **svasyāḥ**—by their own; **prakṛiteḥ**—modes of nature; **jñāna-vān**—the wise; **api**—even; **prakṛitim**—nature; **yānti**—follow; **bhūtāni**—all living beings; **nigrahaḥ**—repression; **kiṁ**—what; **kariṣhyati**—will do

Even a wise man acts according to his own nature. Beings follow nature; what can restraint do?

VERSE 3.34

इन्द्रियस्येन्द्रियस्यार्थे रागद्वेषौ व्यवस्थितौ ।
तयोर्न वशमागच्छेत्तौ ह्यस्य परिपन्थिनौ ॥ 34 ॥

indriyasyendriyasyārthe rāga-dveṣhau vyavasthitau
tayor na vaśham āgachchhet tau hyasya paripanthinau

indriyasya—of the senses; **indriyasya arthe**—in the sense objects; **rāga**—attachment; **dveṣhau**—aversion; **vyavasthitau**—situated; **tayoḥ**—of them; **na**—never; **vaśham**—be controlled; **āgachchhet**—should become; **tau**—those; **hi**—certainly; **asya**—for him; **paripanthinau**—foes

In each of the senses abide attraction and repulsion for the objects of the senses. One should not come under their sway, for they are man's enemies.

039. Chapter 3 Verses 35-37

VERSE 3.35

श्रेयान्स्वधर्मो विगुणः परधर्मात्स्वनुष्ठितात् ।
स्वधर्मे निधनं श्रेयः परधर्मो भयावहः ॥ 35 ॥

śhreyān swa-dharmo viguṇaḥ para-dharmāt sv-anuṣṭhitāt
swa-dharme nidhanam śhreyaḥ para-dharmo bhayāvahaḥ

śhreyān—better; **swa-dharmaḥ**—personal duty; **viguṇaḥ**—tinged with faults; **para-dharmāt**—than another's prescribed duties; **su-anuṣṭhitāt**—perfectly done; **swa-dharme**—in one's personal duties; **nidhanam**—death; **śhreyaḥ**—better; **para-dharmaḥ**—duties prescribed for others; **bhaya-āvahaḥ**—fraught with fear

One's own duty, ill-performed and without merit, is better than the duty of another well-discharged. Better is death in discharging one's own duty. Another's duty is fraught with fear.

VERSE 3.36

अर्जुन उवाच ।

अथ केन प्रयुक्तोऽयं पापं चरति पूरुषः ।

अनिच्छन्नपि वार्ष्णेय बलादिव नियोजितः ॥ 36 ॥

arjuna uvācha

atha kena prayukto 'yaṁ pāpaṁ charati pūruṣhaḥ

anichchhann api vārṣhṇeya balād iva niyojitaḥ

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **atha**—then; **kena**—by what; **prayuktaḥ**—impelled; **ayam**—one; **pāpam**—sins; **charati**—commit; **pūruṣhaḥ**—a person; **anichchhan**—unwillingly; **api**—even; **vārṣhṇeya**—he who belongs to the Vrishni clan, Shree Krishna; **balāt**—by force; **iva**—as if; **niyojitaḥ**—engaged

Arjuna said: O Krishna! Constrained by force as it were, by what does man commit sin even against his wish?

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

काम एष क्रोध एष रजोगुणसमुद्भवः ॥

महाशनो महापाप्मा विद्ध्येनमिह वैरिणम् ॥ 37 ॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

kāma eṣha krodha eṣha rajo-guṇa-samudbhavaḥ

mahāśhano mahā-pāpmā viddhyenam iha vairiṇam

śhri-bhagavān uvācha—the Supreme Lord said; **kāmaḥ**—desire; **eṣhaḥ**—this; **krodhaḥ**—wrath; **eṣhaḥ**—this; **rajaḥ-guṇa**—the mode of passion; **samudbhavaḥ**—born of; **mahā-aśhanaḥ**—all-devouring; **mahā-pāpmā**—greatly sinful; **viddhi**—know; **enam**—this; **iha**—in the material world; **vairiṇam**—the enemy

The Blessed Lord said: It is desire, it is anger, born of Rajoguna (the impulse of action), all-consuming and all-evil. Know this as the enemy here.

040. Chapter 3 Verses 38-39

VERSE 3.38

धूमेनाव्रियते वह्निर्यथादर्शो मलेन च ।
यथोल्बेनावृतो गर्भस्तथा तेनेदमावृतम् ॥ 38 ॥

dhūmenāvriyate vahnir yathādarśho malena cha
yatholbenāvṛito garbhas tathā tenedam āvṛitam

dhūmena—by smoke; **āvriyate**—is covered; **vahniḥ**—fire; **yathā**—just as; **ādarśhaḥ**—mirror; **malena**—by dust; **cha**—also; **yathā**—just as; **ulbena**—by the womb; **āvṛitaḥ**—is covered; **garbhaḥ**—embryo; **tathā**—similarly; **tena**—by that (desire); **idam**—this; **āvṛitam**—is covered

As fire is enveloped by smoke, as a mirror by dust, as an embryo by the amnion, so this knowledge of the Self is enveloped by Kama and Krodha.

VERSE 3.39

आवृतं ज्ञानमेतेन ज्ञानिनो नित्यवैरिणा ।
कामरूपेण कौन्तेय दुष्पूरेणानलेन च ॥ ३९ ॥

āvṛitaṁ jñānam etena jñānino nitya-vairiṇā
kāma-rūpeṇa kaunteya duṣhpūreṇānalena cha

āvṛitam—covered; **jñānam**—knowledge; **etena**—by this; **jñāninaḥ**—of the wise;
nitya-vairiṇā—by the perpetual enemy; **kāma-rūpeṇa**—in the form of desires;
kaunteya—Arjun the son of Kunti; **duṣhpūreṇa**—insatiable; **analena**—like fire;
cha—and

**O Arjuna! Knowledge of the Self is covered by this
everlasting foe of the wise in the form of desire, insatiable
like fire.**

041. Chapter 3 Verses 40-42

VERSE 3.40

इन्द्रियाणि मनो बुद्धिरस्याधिष्ठानमुच्यते ।
एतैर्विमोहयत्येष ज्ञानमावृत्य देहिनम् ॥ 40 ॥

indriyāṇi mano buddhir asyādhīṣṭhānam uchyate
etair vimohayatyeṣha jñānam āvṛitya dehinam

indriyāṇi—the senses; **manah**—the mind; **buddhiḥ**—the intellect; **asya**—of this; **adhīṣṭhānam**—dwelling place; **uchyate**—are said to be; **etaiḥ**—by these; **vimohayati**—deludes; **eṣhaḥ**—this; **jñānam**—knowledge; **āvṛitya**—clouds; **dehinam**—the embodied soul

The senses, the mind, and the intellect are the seat of kama. Functioning through them this kama deluded the embodied by veiling the wisdom.

VERSE 3.41

तस्मात्त्वमिन्द्रियाण्यादौ नियम्य भरतर्षभ ।
पाप्मानं प्रजहि ह्येनं ज्ञानविज्ञाननाशनम् ॥ 41 ॥

tasmāt tvam indriyāṇyādaу niyamyā bharatarṣhabha
pāpmānam prajahi hyenam jñāna-vijñāna-nāśhanam

tasmāt—therefore; **tvam**—you; **indriyāṇi**—senses; **ādaу**—in the very beginning; **niyamyā**—having controlled; **bharata-ṛṣhabha**—Arjun, the best of the Bharatas; **pāpmānam**—the sinful; **prajahi**—slay; **hi**—certainly; **enam**—this; **jñāna**—knowledge; **vijñāna**—realization; **nāśhanam**—the destroyer

O Arjuna! Therefore, having controlled the senses in the beginning, kill surely this kama, the sinful destroyer of knowledge and Self-realisation.

VERSE 3.42

इन्द्रियाणि पराण्याहुरिन्द्रियेभ्यः परं मनः ।
मनसस्तु परा बुद्धिर्यो बुद्धेः परतस्तु सः ॥ 42 ॥

indriyāṇi parāṇyāhur indriyebhyaḥ param manah
manasas tu parā buddhir yo buddheḥ paratas tu saḥ

indriyāṇi—senses; **parāṇi**—superior; **āhuḥ**—are said; **indriyebhyaḥ**—than the senses; **param**—superior; **manah**—the mind; **manasaḥ**—than the mind; **tu**—but; **parā**—superior; **buddhiḥ**—intellect; **yaḥ**—who; **buddheḥ**—than the intellect; **parataḥ**—more superior; **tu**—but; **saḥ**—that (soul)

They say that the senses are superior (to the body), superior to the senses is the mind, superior to the mind is the intellect, but superior than the intellect is He (the Atman).

042. Chapter 3 Verse 43 - Ch3 Overview

VERSE 3.43

एवं बुद्धेः परं बुद्ध्वा संस्तभ्यात्मानमात्मना ।
जहि शत्रुं महाबाहो कामरूपं दुरासदम् ॥ 43 ॥

evam buddheḥ param buddhvā sanstabhyātmānam ātmanā
jahi śhatrum mahā-bāho kāma-rūpaṁ durāsadam

evam—thus; **buddheḥ**—than the intellect; **param**—superior; **buddhvā**—knowing; **sanstabhya**—subdue; **ātmānam**—the lower self (senses, mind, and intellect); **ātmanā**—by higher self (soul); **jahi**—kill; **śhatrum**—the enemy; **mahā-bāho**—mighty-armed one; **kāma-rūpaṁ**—in the form of desire; **durāsadam**—formidable

O mighty-armed Arjuna! Thus, having known what is greater than the intellect (i.e.) Atma, and restraining the mind by the intellect conquer the foe (kama) in the form of desire which is indeed hard to overcome.